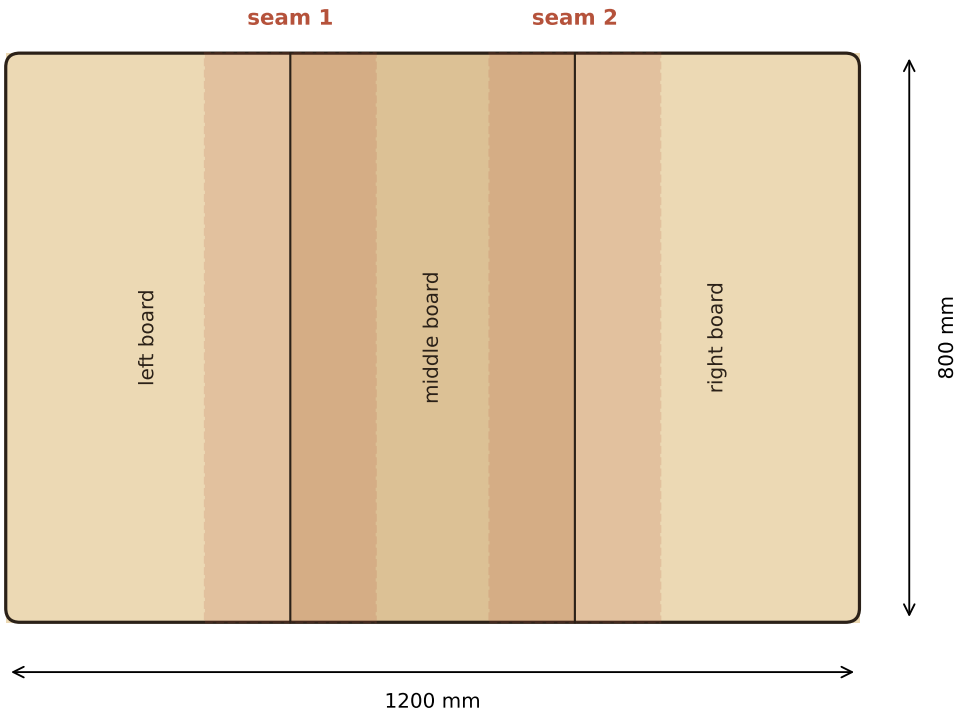
Kotatsu table top: seam design template

Top 1200 x 800 mm, birch plywood 18 mm, made of 3 boards. Scale 1:10.

Shaded = where the seam line may wander: up to 120 mm either side of the straight line.



It must lock.

Picture pulling two boards straight apart. Somewhere the shape has to catch: wider further in than at its opening, like a dovetail or a keyhole. A plain wave or zig-zag slides apart.

No sharp inside corners.

The cutter is a round bit 6.35 mm (1/4") wide, so every inside corner comes out rounded at least that much. Outside points are fine, but they get softened slightly.

Nothing thinner than about 25 mm.

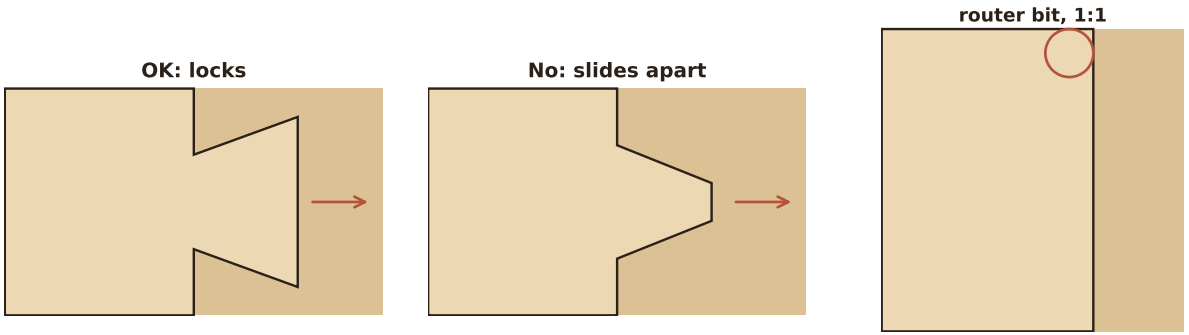
A neck or finger narrower than ~25 mm (1 inch) may crack. Big, confident shapes cut best.

It reads as a line only.

Both boards are the same pale birch. The design shows as a fine dark hairline (a 0.4 mm gap). No colour, no carving (unless we agree to add shallow engraving).

Two seams, each ~800 mm long.

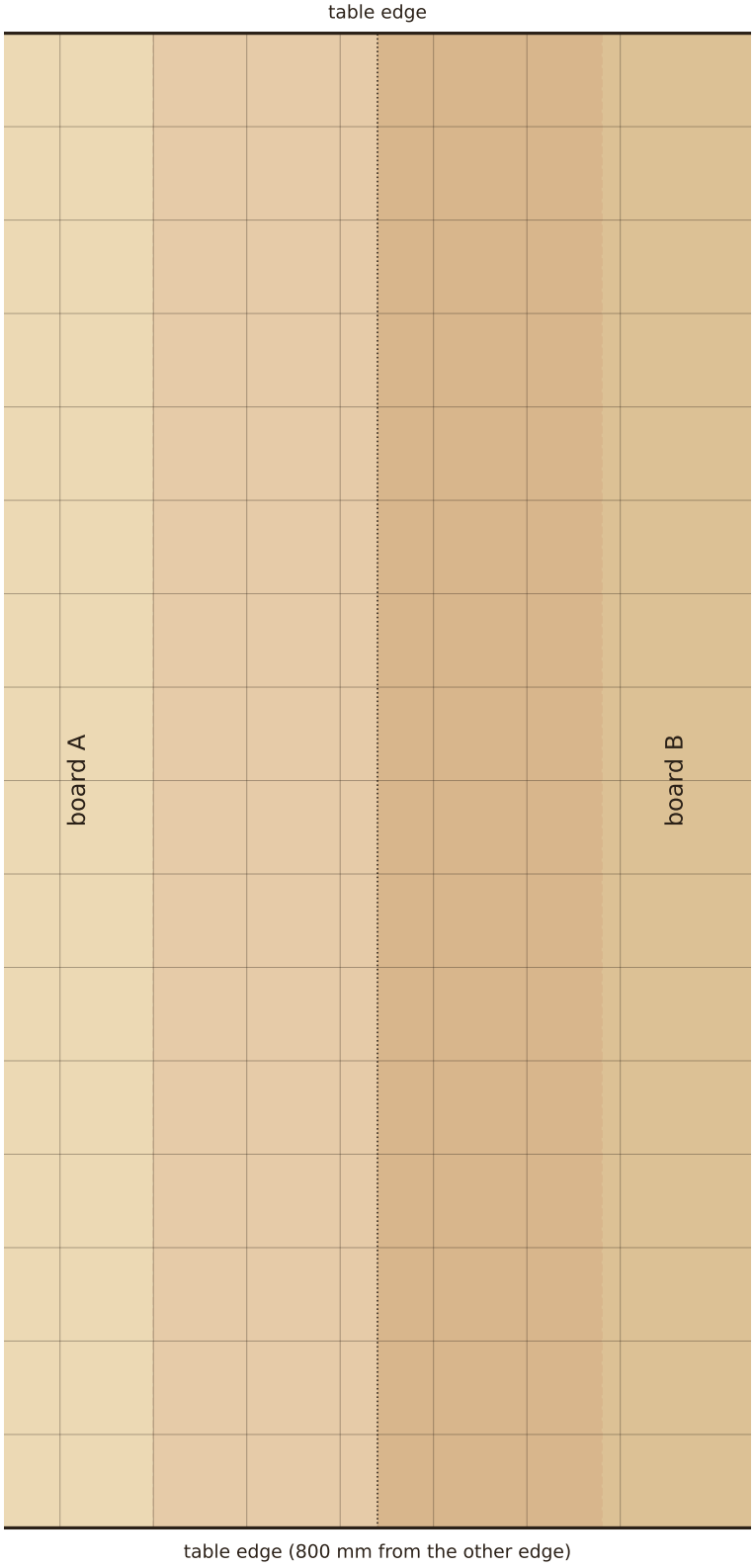
They can be one design and its mirror image, two related designs, or a single design that spans both.



Any medium is fine.

A pencil sketch on page 2 photographed straight on works. So does any vector file (SVG, AI, PDF). I convert it and send back a proof to approve before anything is cut.

Examples at 1:4 except the bit (actual size). Questions welcome; nothing is final until you approve the proof.

Seam sketch sheet, scale 1:4 (1 grid square = 50 mm real)

Draw the line where two boards meet. Stay inside the shaded band. Rules on page 1.